Graduate Extension: What the Constraints Induce, and Whether Closure Finds Mutants, Project 1

What is analyzed. The team's `crv/` layer was still in progress when this was written, so the analysis uses the constraint in `grad/stimulus.py`. It is a two-phase sweep. In FILL, $P(\texttt{wr_en}) = a$ and $P(\texttt{rd_en}) = 1 - a$. DRAIN is the mirror image. At `count` 0 and 8 both enables are 1/2. The phase flips when the *reference* queue reaches full or empty, and the design value is $a = 0.75$. Every request is legal at every occupancy, because the spec defines a write while full and a read while empty. The baseline is an unshaped `UniformTxn`. Stimulus runs through the team's driver, monitor, `FifoEnv` and queue scoreboard, with its own coverage phase, so no directed cycle earns credit. The scripts accept any class with the same fields. The tables below are regenerated when the team class lands.

The rates are measured, not read off the constraint. Each enable is an `implies` on a uniform roll. On the pinned pyvsc that text alone does not deliver its rates. The solver picks the 1-bit enable first and then finds a consistent roll, which pulls every rate toward 0.5. That is the same compression I measured in HW5. Adding `vsc.solve_order(roll, enable)` picks the roll first, and the rates come back. Measured over 2000 draws per state:

state	nominal (p_w, p_r)	with `solve_order`	same text, without
$c = 3$, FILL	$(0.75, 0.25)$	$(0.722, 0.249)$	$(0.637, 0.396)$
$c = 3$, DRAIN	$(0.25, 0.75)$	$(0.247, 0.739)$	$(0.428, 0.662)$
$c = 0$ and $c = 8$	$(0.50, 0.50)$	$(0.495, 0.514)$, $(0.499, 0.502)$	$(0.523, 0.542)$, $(0.526, 0.530)$

Interior drift is +0.47 with the ordering line and +0.24 without it. Every number below comes from a chain built on the *measured* joint request probabilities, not on the constraint text.

The occupancy histogram, against uniform. Count and phase are fed in each cycle and the rolls are fresh, so stimulus is a Markov chain on (c, phase), with 16 reachable states. Solving $\pi P = \pi$ and summing out the phase gives the occupancy the constraints induce. Figure 1 compares that prediction with the RTL histogram from five 1024-draw seeds.

c	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
phased, π	.070	.116	.124	.126	.125	.128	.126	.117	.069
phased, RTL	.072	.122	.130	.127	.118	.118	.128	.118	.067
uniform, π	.063	.125	.134	.129	.122	.116	.123	.127	.061
uniform, RTL	.064	.125	.131	.134	.146	.132	.118	.104	.047

The shaping barely moves the histogram. The total-variation distance between the phased and uniform stationary distributions is 0.033, and each is about 0.09 from flat. Both halve the end states for the same reason HW5 found: an end can only be left one way. If the histogram were the only evidence, the constraint would look like it did nothing.

One number does separate them. The phased RTL histogram is within 0.019 TV of its own π, and uniform is 0.046 from its own. Uniform stimulus is a symmetric random walk, so 5120 draws are not enough to mix. Its count-8 bar is 0.047 against a stationary 0.061. What the constraint changed is the *time* structure: it crosses the FIFO in a straight line instead of diffusing. A histogram cannot show that, so the next part measures time directly.

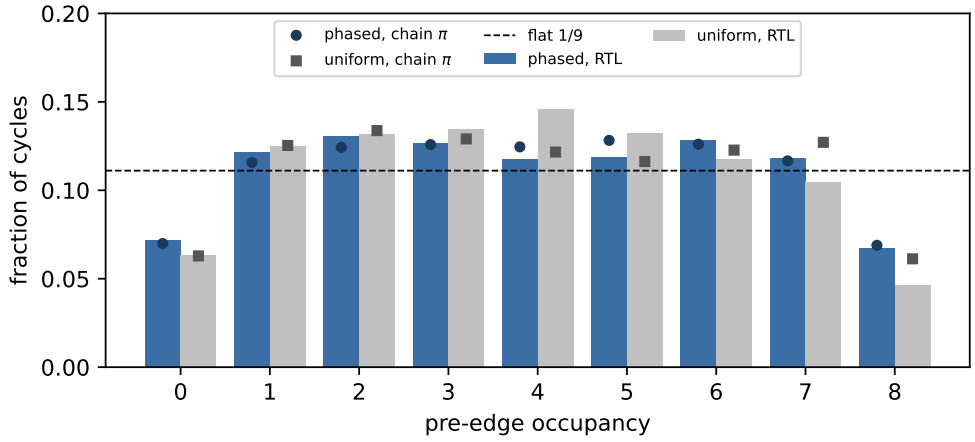


Figure 1: Pre-edge occupancy. Bars are RTL coverage counts over 5×1024 draws; markers are the chain's π.

A constraint that reaches `full` with a read. Name the corner $\mathcal{C}$: pre-edge $c = 8$ and `rd_en` $= 1$ on the same draw. It is a blocked-write and accepted-read boundary, and it covers bins `(8, read)` and `(8, simultaneous)`. Two facts about the constraint make it tractable. Arriving at full flips the phase to DRAIN, where $p_r = 1/2$. The only way out of full is an accepted read, and that read is $\mathcal{C}$. So

$$T_{\mathcal{C}} = T_{\text{fill}} + G, \qquad G \sim \text{Geom}(1/2),$$

and T_{fill} is the first passage $0 \to 8$ of a birth-death chain in FILL. It goes up with $u = a^2$ and down with $d = (1-a)^2$ in the interior. At $c = 0$ it goes up with $u_0 = 1/2$, because there a read is ignored and any write advances. With m_k the expected time from k to $k+1$,

$$m_0 = \frac{1}{u_0}, \qquad m_k = \frac{1 + d\, m_{k-1}}{u}, \qquad E[T_{\text{fill}}] = \sum_{k=0}^{7} m_k,$$

which is 16.0 draws at $a = 0.75$, so $E[T_{\mathcal{C}}] = 18$. The expectation does not bound the tail, so the exact probability comes from making $\mathcal{C}$ absorbing and iterating $e_0 P_{\text{abs}}^N$.

Target: $P(\mathcal{C} \text{ within } N) > p = 0.999$ for $N = 48 = 6 \cdot$ `DEPTH` draws from reset. Sweeping a on the exact chain:

a (FILL write, %)	66	68	70	71	**72**	73	74	75
$P(\mathcal{C}$ within 48)	.9741	.9899	.9967	.9982	**.9991**	.9995	.9998	.9999
$E[T_{\text{fill}}]$	23.5	21.2	19.4	18.6	17.9	17.2	16.6	16.0

So the derived constraint is $a \geq 0.72$ with ends at $1/2$. I use $a = 0.75$. With the measured rates the chain gives 0.9998 at $N = 48$, and it crosses 0.999 at $N = 42$. Figure 2 shows the whole curve. The Monte Carlo runs pyvsc itself against the reference queue. It agrees with the chain in every row, but 3000 seeds cannot tell 0.9993 from 0.9998; that would need about 10^5. The RTL regression agrees too. The phased runs hit $\mathcal{C}$ in 3/5 seeds at $N = 16$, where the chain predicts 0.42, and in 5/5 from $N = 32$ (0.985). Uniform hits it in 1/5 at 64 (0.30), 3/5 at 128 (0.62), 4/5 at 256 (0.89), and 5/5 at 512 (0.99). Note the gap between the first two rows: the `solve_order` line alone cuts the

stimulus	chain, P_{48}	N for 0.999	pyvsc, 3000 seeds, P_{48} [95% CI]
phased, `solve_order`	.9998	42	.9993 [.9976, .9998]
phased text, no ordering	.8981	101	.8997 [.8884, .9099]
uniform	.1934	751	.1897 [.1760, .2041]

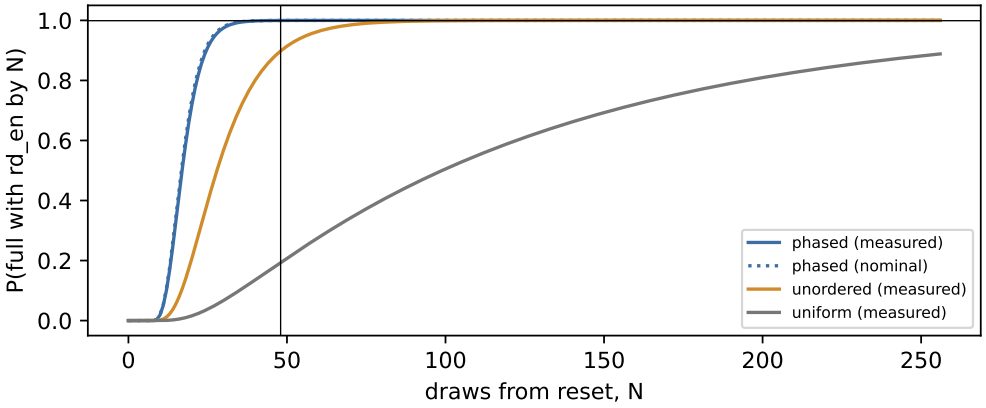


Figure 2: Exact $P(\mathcal{C}$ within $N)$ from each measured chain. The lines mark $N = 48$ and $p = 0.999$.

required N by 2.4×. And the uniform walk needs 18× more draws for the corner while spending almost the same fraction of its time at full. That is the dwell versus traversal trade again, measured this time instead of argued.

Does closing holes find more mutants? The regression is 2 stimuli × 8 budgets ($N = 8, \ldots, 1024$) × 5 seeds, 80 points in all. Each point is a clean run that exports X1 (occupancy × request, 36 bins), then the released pool through the course harness with identical settings. The harness reruns clean RTL first, so that is 800 simulations, and every found outcome is `test-failed`.

N	8	16	32	64	128	256	512	1024
phased: mean X1 bins	7.8	13.8	23.8	29.8	34.0	36	36	36
phased: mean found	5.0	6.8	7.6	7.8	8.0	8.0	8.0	8.0
uniform: mean X1 bins	6.4	10.2	15.8	20.6	30.2	34.2	36	36
uniform: mean found	5.0	5.8	6.2	6.4	7.4	7.8	8.0	8.0

Across all 80 points, Spearman $\rho = 0.87$ (Pearson 0.91). That headline overstates the link, for four reasons.

- **Closure was sufficient, not necessary.** All 29 runs that closed X1 found 8/8. But 18 runs found 8/8 with holes still open, one of them at only 15/36 bins. After a run reaches 8/8, closing its remaining holes bought nothing on this pool.
- **A few specific bins carry the correlation.** `ignore_full` was found in 47/47 runs that hit `(8, write)` or `(8, simultaneous)`, and in 0/33 that did not. `full_offbyone` was found in 54/54 runs that reached occupancy 7, and in 0/26 that did not. Those are the boundary bins a diffusing walk reaches late. That is why phased reaches 8/8 at $N = 128$ and uniform needs $N = 512$.

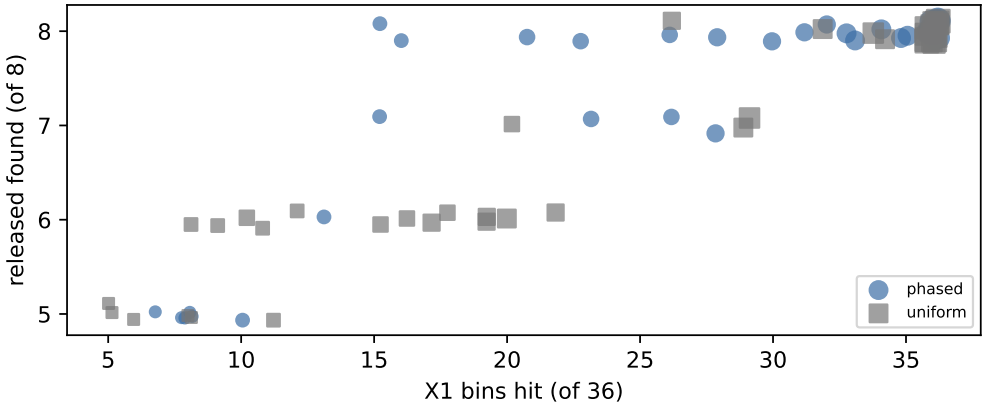


Figure 3: X1 bins against released found, one marker per point (jittered; size grows with N).

- **X1 is silent on the other classes.** `empty_offbyone`, `count_wr_dec`, `rd_data_wrptr` and `mem_corrupt` were found in all 80 runs, including the 8-draw ones. `ignore_empty` was found in 6 runs that never sampled a read at empty. The unsampled final drain did it, so the credit belongs to the drain, not to a bin. `wrptr_wrap_early` depends on the number of writes since reset, which no X1 bin records: 0/10 at $N = 8$, 8/10 at $N = 16$, all from $N = 32$.
- **Both variables grow with N.** Within a single budget, ρ is 0.71 to 0.85 for $N = 16$ to 256. That mostly separates phased from uniform at the same N, which is the boundary-bin mechanism above, not evidence that bins in general predict detection.

So the answer is yes, for the holes a mutant's activation condition actually lives in. It is no for the cross as a whole. Closure is a useful sign-off check because it forces the boundary bins, but the queue scoreboard, the drain and traversal count are what found the other half of the pool. For the team suite this argues for a pointer-wrap coverpoint (writes since reset, in units of `DEPTH`) next to X1. Any fault class that X1 cannot see will not show up in this correlation either.

Limits. Five seeds per point. The released pool has eight mutants, and the hidden pool may weight the classes differently. WIDTH and DEPTH are both 8. The constraint analyzed is the extension's own, not the team's final `crv/` class. Commands, seeds and per-run stream hashes are in `grad/README.md` and `grad/results/`. All 80 streams are distinct, and rerunning `analyze.py` reproduces `analysis.json` byte for byte.

AI Assistance Disclosure

I used a general-purpose frontier assistant, terminal interface, to implement the analysis scripts, run the regression, and draft this write-up. Every number is taken from the logged results in `grad/results/`. The predictions, evidence and fixes are recorded in `ai_log.md`. The relevant prompt:

```
"Help me complete my portion of my verification/validation group project
... Also help me complete the graduate extension as a latex file ... Make
sure to include AI disclosures where appropriate."
```

Accessed on 10/31/26.